

# Senior Benefits & Eldercare

From in-home care to help paying for it, older adults and their families have real options. Below are the main national starting points for benefits and care. Tick the box once you've checked each one.

## ⚠ BEFORE YOU START

You don't have to navigate aging alone. Free counselors help you find benefits and care, and programs exist to pay for in-home help so seniors can stay at home longer. Applying is free.

## 1 Find Benefits You're Owed

Free tools to uncover money and help you qualify for.

### ☐ BenefitsCheckUp

Free screening for 2,000+ benefit programs for older adults.

→ [www.benefitscheckup.org](http://www.benefitscheckup.org)

### ☐ Eldercare Locator

Free connection to your local Area Agency on Aging and services.

→ [eldercare.acl.gov](http://eldercare.acl.gov) 1-800-677-1110

## 2 Help Paying for Care

Programs that cover in-home and long-term care.

### ☐ Medicaid & Home-Based Care Waivers

Medicaid can cover nursing homes and in-home care; HCBS waivers help seniors stay at home.

→ [www.medicaid.gov/medicaid/long-term-services-supports/home-community-based-services/index.html](http://www.medicaid.gov/medicaid/long-term-services-supports/home-community-based-services/index.html)

### ☐ PACE — All-Inclusive Care for the Elderly

A program combining medical and in-home support to help you stay in your community.

→ [www.medicare.gov/health-drug-plans/health-plans/your-coverage-options/PACE](http://www.medicare.gov/health-drug-plans/health-plans/your-coverage-options/PACE)

### ☐ VA Aid & Attendance

Extra pension for veterans (and surviving spouses) who need help with daily activities. VA help is free — never pay a consultant.

→ [www.va.gov/pension/aid-attendance-housebound](http://www.va.gov/pension/aid-attendance-housebound) 1-877-222-8387

## 3 Stay at Home Safely

Support and services for daily living.

### ☐ In-Home Support & Meals

Home-delivered meals, personal care, and homemaker services through your Area Agency on Aging.

→ [eldercare.acl.gov](http://eldercare.acl.gov) 1-800-677-1110

### ☐ Get Paid as a Family Caregiver

Medicaid self-directed care may pay a family member to provide care. See the Caregivers guide.

→ [www.medicaid.gov/medicaid/long-term-services-supports/self-directed-services](http://www.medicaid.gov/medicaid/long-term-services-supports/self-directed-services)

## 4 Plan Ahead

Free help with decisions and paperwork.

### ☐ Long-Term Care Planning

Free, unbiased guidance on care options and how to pay. Ask your Area Agency on Aging or SHIP.

→ [acl.gov/ltc](https://acl.gov/ltc)

#### ⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Avoid “senior benefit” or “VA pension” consultants who charge fees — applying for these is free, and paying for help can even disqualify you. Use the free Eldercare Locator and SHIP counselors instead.

#### ★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Ask specifically about Medicaid “Home and Community-Based Services (HCBS) waivers” — they can pay for in-home care so a senior can stay home instead of entering a nursing facility.

#### NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

### Need help where you live?

This guide covers national programs. For your local Area Agency on Aging and care options, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID

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